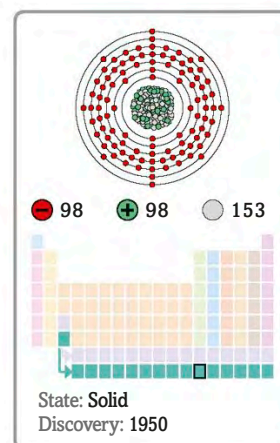


98
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Californium



Water detector

This machine uses californium to find water underground.



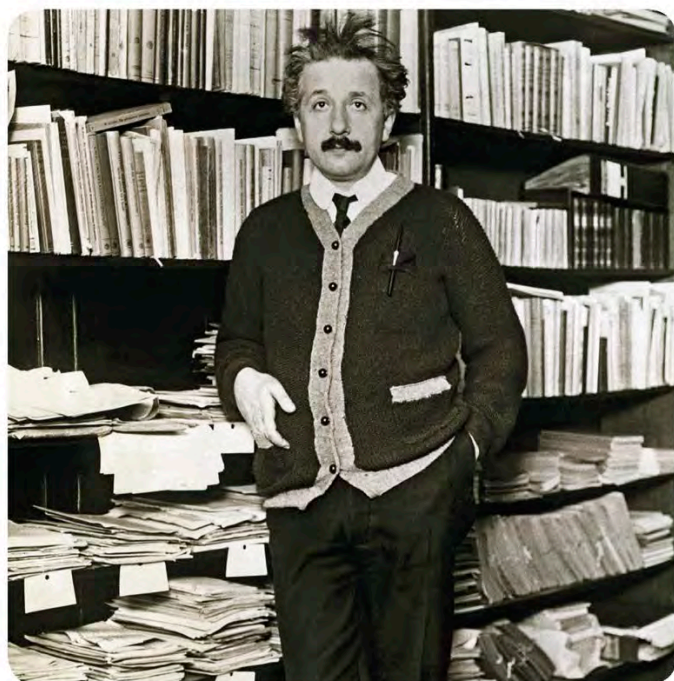
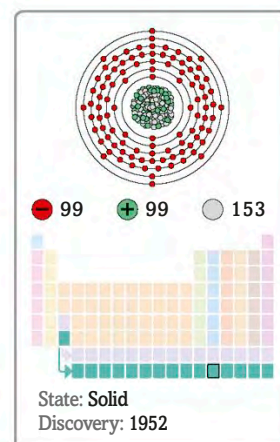
Pellets of radioactive californium

This isotope, or form, of californium produces a lot of neutrons.

Californium is named after the US state of **California**. This soft, silvery metal does not exist in nature and is made by smashing berkelium atoms with neutrons in a particle accelerator (a machine in which atoms are smashed together). This **radioactive element** is used in the treatment of cancer.

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Einsteinium



Albert Einstein in his study

Only a **few milligrams** of einsteinium are made **every year**.

Einsteinium was discovered in the chemicals left over after the first hydrogen bomb test in 1952. The huge explosion fused smaller atoms together to make larger ones, including einsteinium. This element was named after the great German-born scientist **Albert Einstein**, and was found to be a silvery, radioactive metal that glows blue in the dark. It is only used for making heavier elements, such as mendelevium.